anæmia, nervous irritability, disorder of the brain, dyspepsia. The normal impulses of the heart are already given in the body of this book. But the pulse is an important factor in determining the nature of given abnormal conditions. In disease the pulse may be natural or strong, weak, firm, yielding, full, small, bounding, compressible, rapid, slow, quick, jerking, hard, soft, tense, gaseous, corded, wiry, thready, imperceptible, regular, irregular, intermittent, dicrotus. Without stopping to define all these terms, as that may with propriety be referred to the medical lexicographer, it is not out of place to say that only skill, combined with much practice, is able to recognize the distinction between a rapid and quick pulse and a full and strong one, yet to be able to do this is very important to the practitioner.

The fever pulse is moderately accelerated with an increase of force to the impulse of the heart. But the pulse of inflammation is hard, tense, and full.

When nervous irritation is the disturbing cause, the pulse is usually quick and variable, in rapidity and force, as the patient may be either in a state of excitement or repose.

A jerking pulse indicates valvular disease. In extreme debility the pulse is usually very rapid, and very small or "thready." Irregularity of the pulse is too general, and due to too many causes, to have any special pathological value.

The dicrotus, or double pulse, is to be met with in continued fevers, and is always indicative of a want of tone in the muscular fibres of the arteries, giving rise to a perceptible interval between their impulse and the impulse of the ventricles of the heart.

The blood itself furnishes the most reliable data in determining the nature of morbid changes in the system. But as these peculiarities require microscopic inspection and chemical analysis, reference can only be made to the fact, leaving the demonstration to the pathologist and the chemist.

Hemorrhages.—Epistaxis, or bleeding at the nose; hæmoptysis, or spitting of blood; hæmatemesis, or vomiting of blood; hæmaturia, or bloody urine; uterine hemorrhage; hemorrhage